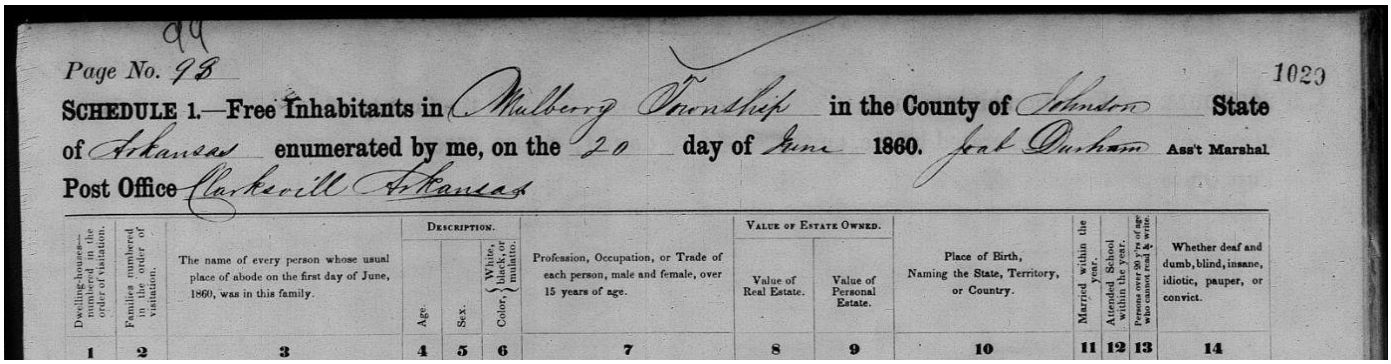
Source A: a household in the 1860 census

Core lesson | S01 | v21.2 | Read the printed aid as well as the image

Review draft: the editing assistant compared these crops with the originals; independent human source review and classroom piloting remain pending.

Spencer Horner appears in a population schedule for **Mulberry Township, Johnson County, Arkansas**, with Clarksville as the post office. The form collected information about people and reported property. It did not include a column naming each person's relationship to the head of household.



Page No. 98 99 1029

SCHEDULE 1.—Free Inhabitants in Mulberry Township in the County of Johnson State of Arkansas enumerated by me, on the 20 day of June 1860. Jas Durham Ass't Marshal.

Post Office Clarksville Arkansas

Dwelling-houses numbered in the order of visitation.	Families numbered in the order of visitation.	The name of every person whose usual place of abode on the first day of June, 1860, was in this family.	Description. Age.	Sex.	Color, (white, black, or mulatto.)	Profession, Occupation, or Trade of each person, male and female, over 15 years of age.	Value of Estate Owned. Value of Real Estate.	Value of Personal Estate.	Place of Birth, Naming the State, Territory, or Country.	Married within the year.	Attended School within the year.	Persons over 20 y'rs of age who cannot read & write.	Whether deaf and dumb, blind, insane, idiotic, pauper, or convict.
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14

Two dates on one record

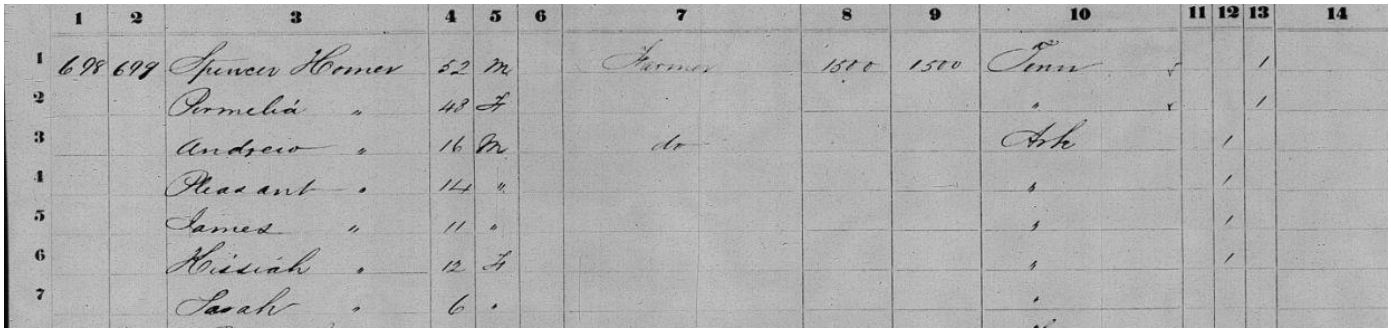
- **1 June 1860: reference date.** Column 3 asks who lived in the family on that date.
- **20 June 1860: enumeration date.** The handwritten page heading dates the enumerator's recording.

The two dates answer different questions. Do not use 20 June as the household's reference date.

Locator: dwelling 698, family 699, lines 1–7; Page No. appears 98 with another handwritten 99; stamped 1029. Original scan extracted from page 1 of the owner's “1860 census” export. NARA microfilm series/ roll and provider image ID remain unverified. This is a provisional local citation, not a complete archival citation.

About the detail: a rectangular crop of the source image, without altered letters, contrast enhancement or reconstructed handwriting. The full original remains available for comparison: https://daniel-lingar.github.io/horner-archive/sources/reviewed/1860-mulberry-spencer-horner.jpeg

Source A: household detail and reading aid



Partial transcription supplied for this lesson

Line	Name / reading	Age / sex	Occupation or reported property	Birthplace
1	Spencer Horner	52 / M	Farmer; real estate 1500; personal estate 1500	Tennessee
2	Permelia	Age not resolved / F	No separate valuation entered here	Tennessee, ditto
3	Andrew, provisional	16 / M	Ditto occupation, farmer	Arkansas
4	Pleasant, provisional	14 / M	No occupation transcribed	Arkansas, ditto
5	James, provisional	11 / M	No occupation transcribed	Arkansas, ditto
6	Given name not confidently read	13 / F	No occupation transcribed	Arkansas, ditto
7	Sarah, provisional	6 / F	No occupation transcribed	Arkansas, ditto

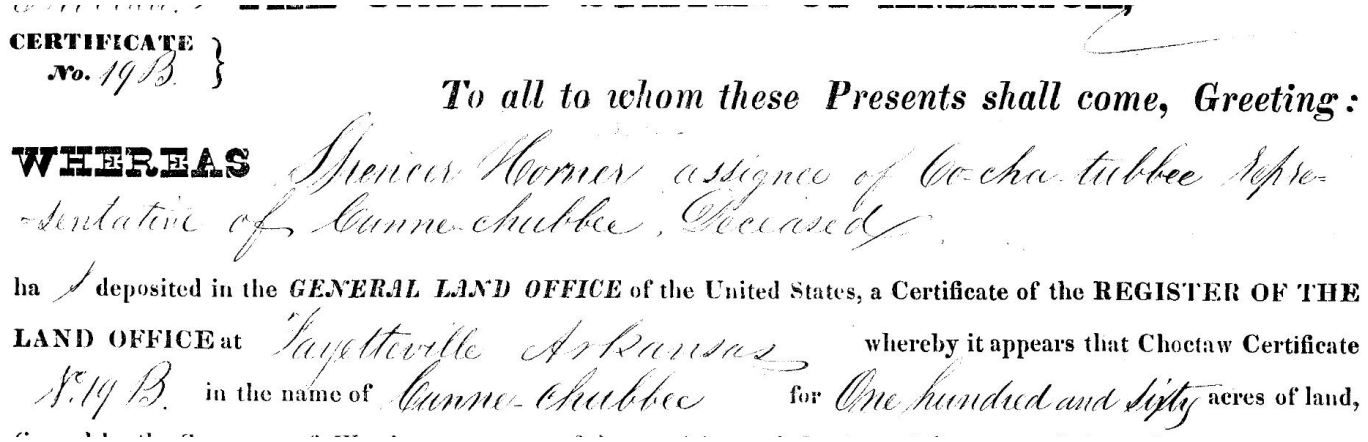
Uncertain readings are not scored. “Ditto” means a mark repeats the entry above; this is an editorial explanation. Do not confuse Permelia on line 2 with a similarly named person in the following household on the full page.

Column key, following the original form: 1 dwelling number; 2 family number; 3 name at the June 1 reference date; 4 age; 5 sex; 6 color, using the form's historical categories; 7 occupation for persons over 15; 8 real-estate value; 9 personal-estate value; 10 birthplace; 11 married within the year; 12 attended school within the year; 13 persons over 20 unable to read/write; 14 disability, poverty or conviction labels used by the historical form. Those labels reflect the period's administration, not language students are asked to apply to people.

Read precisely: “Personal estate 1500” is a reported value. The entry does not list each possession, establish a purchase price for the patent, or state a motive for violence. The age permits an approximate birth-year calculation; it is not an exact birth date.

Source B: the land patent and Choctaw certificate

Core lesson | S02 | Federal document dated 1 April 1857



CERTIFICATE
No. 19B

To all to whom these Presents shall come, Greeting:

WHEREAS Spencer Horner assignee of Co-cha-tubbee Representative of Canne Chubbee, Deceased

has deposited in the *GENERAL LAND OFFICE* of the United States, a Certificate of the **REGISTER OF THE LAND OFFICE** at Fayetteville Arkansas whereby it appears that Choctaw Certificate No. 19 B. in the name of Canne Chubbee for One hundred and Sixty acres of land,

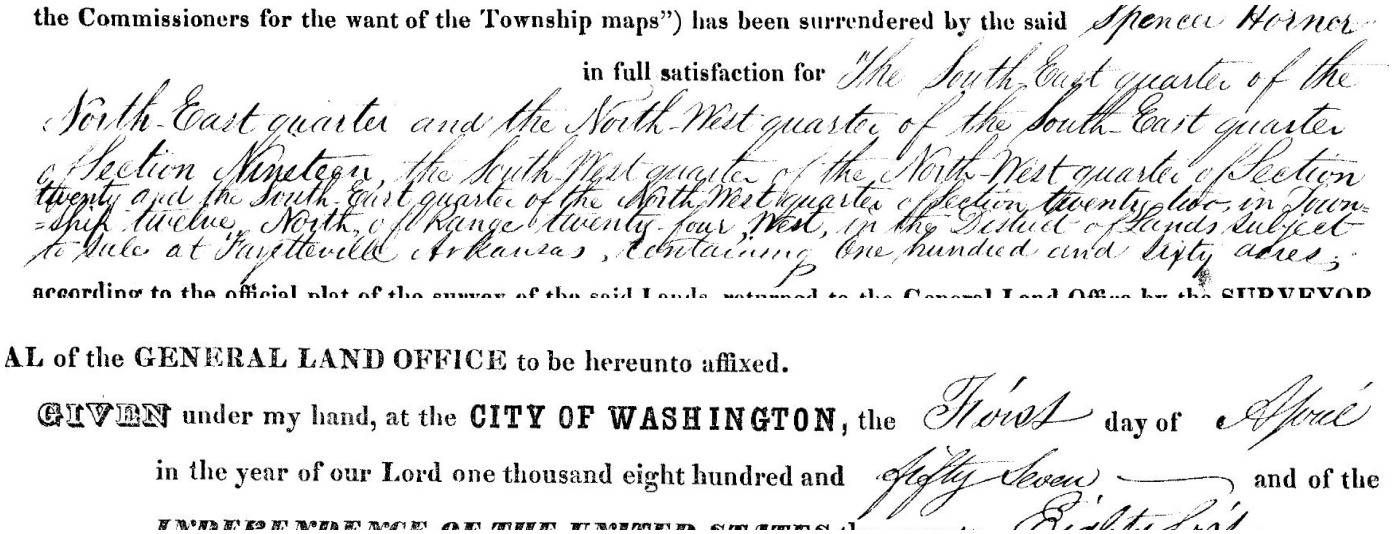
Partial reading, with punctuation normalized

- Spencer Horner is named as **assignee of Co-cha-tubbee, representative of Canne Chubbee, deceased**.
- The printed wording identifies a **Choctaw Certificate**; the written number is **19B**.
- The certificate is in the name of **Canne Chubbee**, for **one hundred and sixty acres**.
- The document cites the **Treaty of Dancing Rabbit Creek** and later federal acts.

An **assignee** receives rights through an assignment. A **certificate** is the claim instrument referenced by this document. A **patent** is the government's formal land-grant document. Certificate No. 19B should not automatically be treated as a verified catalog accession or patent number. Original BLM/GLO accession and document fields remain to be checked.

The Choctaw names and treaty connection belong in the land's history. The Choctaw Nation describes the 1830 treaty in relation to forced removal and provisions for people remaining in Mississippi. That context does not tell us the price, circumstances or fairness of this particular later assignment. Source for context: Choctaw Nation, “The Treaty that Forever Changed our Chahta People's Story,” https://www.choctawnation.com/news/chiefs-blog/the-treaty-that-forever-changed-our-chahta-peoples-story/

Source B: land description, date and limits



the Commissioners for the want of the Township maps") has been surrendered by the said Spencer Horner
in full satisfaction for The South East quarter of the North East quarter and the North West quarter of the South East quarter of Section Nineteen, the South West quarter of the North West quarter of Section twenty and the South East quarter of the North West quarter of Section twenty two in Township twelve North of Range twenty four West, in the District of Lands subject to Sale at Fayetteville Arkansas, containing One hundred and sixty acres;
according to the official plat of the survey of the said Lands returned to the General Land Office by the SURVEYOR

AL of the GENERAL LAND OFFICE to be hereunto affixed.

GIVEN under my hand, at the CITY OF WASHINGTON, the First day of April
in the year of our Lord one thousand eight hundred and Fifty Seven and of the

Reading aid and limits

The record describes a total of **160 acres** in **sections 19 and 22, Township 12 North, Range 24 West**, associated with the Fayetteville Land Office. The date clause reads **1 April 1857**. The first tract reads **South East quarter of the North East quarter**, section 19. A complete independent reading of all four tracts, particularly the crowded third tract, remains pending. Students are not assessed on disputed aliquot readings.

The patent identifies Spencer as an assignee; it does **not** establish his Indigenous ancestry, the price of the assignment or a modern house site. The people named in a claim transaction need not be relatives. To learn a transaction's consideration, a historian could seek the original assignment or a related deed.

Provenance: existing repository image; handwritten “426” at upper left and Certificate No. 19B in the image. Original archival accession remains unverified. These details are exact rectangular crops, not enhanced or rewritten handwriting. Full image: https://daniel-lingar.github.io/horner-archive/Patent_19B_AR2690___426.jpg

Compare A and B: Which describes a household? Which records a land grant? What does each date refer to? Why is a $1,500 census valuation not the price paid for a certificate three years earlier?

Student worksheet: record, inference, or unsupported claim?

v21.2 | Core sources A and B | No internet needed

Class/date _____ Teacher-selected anonymous identifier _____

Before the lesson: three classifications

Mini-evidence: a census entry records Spencer's age as 52 in 1860; the page heading is dated 20 June. A land patent calls Spencer an assignee and identifies a Choctaw certificate. Use **D** for directly supported; **I** for a reasonable inference; **N** for a claim this evidence does not support. Answer before instruction; do not erase these answers later.

Item	Claim	Before: D / I / N
P1	The census page's enumeration heading is dated 20 June 1860.	
P2	If the reported age is accurate, Spencer was born about 1808.	
P3	The Choctaw certificate proves Spencer's Indigenous ancestry.	

1. Compare the two core sources

Question	A: census	B: patent
What was this kind of record made to do?		
What date(s) appear, and what does each refer to?		
One statement directly supported by this record?		
One question this record cannot answer?		

Student worksheet: classify and explain

D: directly supported means the record explicitly states it. **I: reasonable inference** means a conclusion follows from evidence with a stated assumption or limit. **N: not supported by these sources** means the evidence supplied does not establish the claim; that does not necessarily mean it is false.

---

2. Classify five claims

Write D, I or N and a short reason. Identify A or B. Different answers need evidence and an explanation, not just a different letter.

1. The census heading identifies Mulberry Township. ____ Source ____

Reason: _____

1. If the age 52 is accurate, Spencer was born about 1808. ____ Source ____

Reason: _____

1. Spencer paid exactly $1,500 for the 1857 certificate. ____ Source ____

Reason: _____

1. The land patent refers to a Choctaw certificate. ____ Source ____

Reason: _____

1. Everyone listed in Spencer's census household was his child. ____ Source ____

Reason: _____

Date check

The census reference date is _____. Its enumeration date is _____.
Explain why these dates can differ:

Choose a next record

To investigate the assignment price OR a household relationship, I would look for:

The specific question it might answer is: _____

Student worksheet: write a public-history label

3. Explain what these records tell us

Write **100–150 words**. Include two accurate statements, references **[A]** and **[B]**, one clear limit, and a specific next record with the question it might answer. You may include an inference if you label its assumption. You do not need to decode uncertain handwriting or discuss killings.

After the lesson: repeat the three classifications

Use D, I or N. These are the same items as before, allowing a matched comparison.

Item	Claim	After: D / I / N
P1	The census page's enumeration heading is dated 20 June 1860.	
P2	If the reported age is accurate, Spencer was born about 1808.	
P3	The Choctaw certificate proves Spencer's Indigenous ancestry.	

Anonymous feedback: The enlarged images were readable: yes / partly / no. One change that would help me use the sheets: _____

Teacher guide: a household, a land grant, and historical evidence

v21.2 | Grades 9–12 / adult learners | 50 minutes | Unpiloted prototype

Goals and preparation

Students distinguish a record's direct statement, a reasonable inference and a claim not supported by the supplied evidence. They compare reference and recording dates, cite two sources in a short label, and propose a useful next record. The assessed core uses only A (census) and B (patent), supplied with enlarged details, printed reading aids and a full 14-column census key. Uncertain handwriting is not scored. No browser, family-history disclosure or visit to a cemetery is required.

Print the three worksheet pages and four source-sheet pages. Give the worksheet's “Before” items before instruction or source distribution; then distribute A and B. Students may read the printed aids throughout. Provide a larger-print copy or read-aloud support as needed. A student can meet every goal using supplied text; handwriting decoding is optional. No graphic violence is included in the core lesson. An optional separate memory extension discusses reported killings and reprisals without graphic injury details; do not include it without an appropriate content notice and teacher decision.

Independent human source review and classroom testing remain pending. The editing assistant has compared the crops with the supplied originals; that is not a named human source sign-off.

Timed sequence

Time	Activity	Student work
0–5	Mini-evidence and three “Before” items; do not teach answers yet	P1–P3 baseline
5–9	Explain D/I/N; distinguish reference date from enumeration date	Mark 1 June and 20 June on A
9–22	Pairs read A and B, including printed aids	Section 1 comparison table
22–30	Classify all five claims, discuss reasons, complete date/next-record prompts	Section 2 and date check
30–44	Write a 100–150 word label using A and B	Section 3, two references and a research question
44–50	Repeat the same P1–P3 items and anonymous readability feedback	Matched exit and feedback

Answer key

Matched Before/After items: P1 D; P2 I; P3 N. An accurate age in 1860 suggests a birth around 1808, with uncertainty about birthday and reporting; an exact date of birth is not supplied. A certificate assignment does not establish the assignee's ancestry.

Section 1: A is a government population schedule; reference date 1 June 1860, enumeration heading 20 June 1860. Accept Spencer's reported age, occupation, township or a clearly identified valuation as a direct statement. It does not explicitly state household relationships or describe the later attack. B is a federal land-grant document dated 1 April 1857, naming an assignee and Choctaw certificate. Its source does not establish the assignment price or ancestry. Do not require memorization of uncertain archival catalog fields or all tract readings.

Section 2: 1 D [A]; 2 I [A]; 3 N [A/B]; 4 D [B]; 5 N [A]. For 3, a census valuation is not the price paid in a different transaction. For 5, co-residence is not a stated parent-child relationship. The word “everyone” is especially unsupported. A student may suggest a cautious relationship hypothesis, but must not treat it as an explicit census statement. Do not award N simply because an answer says “we can never know”; the explanation must identify the missing evidence.

Date check: 1 June is the reference date, 20 June the enumeration date. The enumerator could record information later about the earlier specified date. No inference about an 1864 attack date is required.

Next record: accept a certificate assignment/deed for consideration; marriage, probate or a vital/family record for a specified relationship. Accept other appropriate records if the student explains the particular question and acknowledges they may not settle it.

Model label (100–150 words)

In 1860, a census enumerator listed Spencer Horner as a 52-year-old farmer in Mulberry Township, Arkansas. The entry reports $1,500 in real estate and $1,500 in personal estate [A]. The form asks about the household on 1 June, although the page was recorded on 20 June. A federal land patent dated 1 April 1857 names Spencer as an assignee using a Choctaw certificate for 160 acres [B]. These records document a household and a land grant, but they do not establish the assignment price or Spencer's Indigenous ancestry. A historian could seek the original certificate assignment to investigate what consideration changed hands. Comparing that record with the patent would help explain the transaction without turning a census valuation into a purchase price.

Label rubric: 8 points

Criterion	2 points	1 point	0 points
Source references	Both [A] and [B] used accurately	One reference accurate	Neither used accurately
Evidence	Two accurate, bounded statements	One accurate statement	Unsupported assertions only
Reasoning	Distinguishes record, inference and limit	Some distinction, incompletely explained	Conflates them
Research step	Specific next record and question	Vague record or question	Neither supplied

Record word count separately and invite revision outside 100–150; do not confuse length compliance with historical reasoning. Accept equally careful alternative labels. Never penalize a student for retaining a genuinely uncertain reading.

Evaluation that matches the worksheet

Score P1–P3 out of 3 before and after, using the same anonymous identifier. Report paired completed responses, totals/percentages before and after, unchanged/improved/decreased counts, and missing pairs. Repeated items measure performance on these specific items; familiarity and the small classroom sample limit claims about broader learning. Also report the label rubric out of 8 and readability feedback. A suggested design target is 75% of completed labels scoring at least 6/8, not a claimed result or a student pass/fail rule. No pilot has been conducted. Use the evaluation form to record changes needed before describing the pack as tested.

Teacher pilot record

v21.2 | Unpiloted prototype | No student names or personal disclosures

Session code _____ Date _____ Participants _____ Minutes used _____

Matched Before/After items

Correct key: **P1 D; P2 I; P3 N**. Each student has three opportunities at each time. Match by teacher-selected anonymous identifier.

Completed pairs ___; before-only ___; after-only ___; neither ___

For completed pairs only: before correct ___ / (3 × pairs = ___); after correct ___ / ___

Paired students with a higher score ___; same score ___; lower score ___

Before P1/P2/P3 correct ___ / ___ / ___; after ___ / ___ / ___

Do not compare totals from different numbers of students as though they were paired improvement. Keep missing responses separate. Repeated items and a convenience sample limit the inference.

Label and accessibility

Labels scored ___; 0–3 points ___; 4–5 ___; 6–8 ___; not submitted ___

Labels within 100–150 words ___; revisions invited ___

Student readability feedback: yes ___; partly ___; no ___; missing ___

Image, transcription, vocabulary or timing problem observed: _____

Student-suggested change (anonymous): _____

Support used (large print, read-aloud, other): _____

Revision decision

Specific change _____ Responsible role _____ Target date _____

What evidence will show whether the revision helped? _____

No pilot results are supplied by the archive. This form records actual results only after an agreed pilot.